

GoPaperless Payment Orchestration Architecture

Multi-Provider Async Payment Engine

Tendaworld Engineering (Chris Daniels Ohabo & Bruno Carl Ouko)

1 — FRONTEND LAYER · WEB / MOBILE RUNTIME

usePayment

- Start / retry / resume
- Poll payment status
- Provider locking
- Offline detection

Runtime core

usePaymentRouting

- shouldStartPolling()
- isCallbackFlow()
- isMobileDirectFlow()
- requiresMnoSelection()

FE prediction only

usePaymentRecovery

- checkRecovery()
- resumeRecovery()
- discardRecovery()
- activeReference restore

Hydration recovery

PaymentStep.vue

- Phone input + E164
- MNO detection UX
- Provider selection chips
- Resumable polling UX

UX orchestrator

MNO detection states: idle → detecting → detected / suggested / requires-selection → selected. Provider locked once reference acquired.

HTTP / REST boundary

2 — API LAYER · PAYMENTCONTROLLER

Endpoints

POST /payment/start
POST /payment/charge-mobile
GET /payment/status
GET /payment/verify
GET /payment/mobile-options
POST /payment/callback/daraja
POST /payment/callback/dpo

Controller contract

- Thin orchestration boundary
- Delegates all logic to PaymentService
- No routing ownership
- No retry ownership
- No persistence ownership

Passthrough only

Service boundary

3 — APPLICATION LAYER · PAYMENTS ENGINE

PaymentService

Core orchestration authority

- startPayment() — idempotency + routing
- getPaymentStatus() — DB read-only
- resumePayment() — hydration safe
- verifyPayment() — one-shot UX boost
- syncPaymentStatus() — BG job only
- chargeMobile() — DPO deferred charge
- queryPayment() — Daraja fallback
- handleDarajaCallback()
- handleDpoCallback()

Execution authority

Sub-services

MobileMoneyService

- initiate() — route to Daraja / DPO
- charge() — DPO deferred only
- getMobileOptions()

CardService

- initiateCard() → DPO redirect

VerificationService

- verifyStatus() — DPO polling
- query() — Daraja fallback

FxEngineService

- convert() — KES → local currency
- identityResult() — card bypass

ProviderExecutionState

Lifecycle state machine

INITIATED REQUIRES_SELECTION
EXECUTING RECONCILING SUCCESS
FAILED CANCELLED INVALID_REQUEST

Metadata DTOs

- PaymentMetadataDTO
- ProviderPayloadDTO
- SelectedMnoDTO
- SuggestedMnoDTO
- SelectionDTO

Execution state ≠ business state

Domain intelligence boundary

4 — DOMAIN INTELLIGENCE LAYER · MOBILE MONEY DECISION PIPELINE

PhoneResolutionService

- libphonenumber (single entry)
- E164 normalisation
- Region extraction (ISO)
- Carrier hint (best effort)
- Returns
PaymentPhoneResolutionDTO

Phone → region

MnoDetectionRegistry

- KE, TZ, UG, RW, MW, ZM, ZW
- Prefix → MNO mapping
- Ambiguous prefix flagging
- Multi-match portability detection

HIGH AMBIGUOUS
UNKNOWN

MnoRoutingRegistry

- route() — capability + region + carrier + confidence → MnoRoutingResultDTO
- supportsRegion()
- supportedRegions()
- mnoKey resolution

Routes to provider

PaymentCountryResolver + FxEngine

- region → country, currency, min/max
- KES → local currency conversion
- FX rate lock at payment creation
- Card: identity FX (bypass)
- Daraja: always KES

PHONE RESOLUTION PIPELINE

Phone input (+E164) → libphonenumber parse → Region (ISO) → CountryResolver → currency, limits → MnoDetectionRegistry → confidence →

MnoRoutingRegistry → provider + mnoKey → FxEngine → display amount

AMBIGUOUS or UNKNOWN confidence → requiresUserSelection=true → DPO GetMobilePaymentOptions fetched → chip selector shown to user

Provider adapter boundary — no orchestration crosses here

5 — PROVIDER LAYER · ADAPTERS

DpoProvider

- initiateCard() — CreateTransaction token
- initiateMobileMoney() — CreateTransaction token
- charge() — ChargeTokenMobile
- getMobileOptions() — GetMobilePaymentOptions
- test()

Execution only · No routing · No retry · No persistence

DarajaProvider

- initiateMobileMoney() — STK Push
- query() — MpesaExpressQuery fallback
- test()

Callback-only provider. No polling flow. Query used as fallback when callback delayed (>20s).

Execution only · No routing · No retry · No persistence

External network boundary

6 — EXTERNAL PROVIDERS · APIS

DPO Group

- Card payments — redirect flow
- Mobile money — mobile direct flow
- ChargeTokenMobile (deferred charge)
- GetMobilePaymentOptions (provider list)
- Callback → /payment/callback/dpo

DPO Pay API

Safaricom Daraja

- STK Push → callback flow
- CheckoutRequestID as reference
- Callback → /payment/callback/daraja
- MpesaExpressQuery fallback

Daraja API 2.0

Persistence boundary

7 — PERSISTENCE LAYER · GOPAPERLESS_PAYMENTS

Payment entity — core fields

- paymentAttemptId (idempotency)
- providerReference (lookup key)
- paymentStatus (business state)
- provider / paymentProvider
- phoneE164Digits / region / country
- amount / currency (minor units)
- displayAmount / displayCurrency
- fxRate / fxRateSource / fxRateLockedAt

Orchestration metadata — JSON blob

- providerExecutionState
- executedProvider
- flow (redirect | callback | mobile_direct)
- method (mobile | card)
- selected / suggested / selection
- confidence
- alreadyCharged
- instructions
- providerPayload (init + charge + callback + query snapshots)
- providerError
- context (carrier, region, confidence breakdown)

Metadata is first-class orchestration state

Verification + retry fields

- verificationStatus
- verificationRetryCount
- verificationLastCheckedAt
- nextVerificationAt
- verificationLockedAt (BG job mutex)
- createdAt (expiry reference)
- paidAt
- lastErrorCode / lastErrorMessage

15 min expiry window

Data flow examples

8 — DATA FLOWS

Flow 1 · Card / Redirect

FE startPayment(card) → CardService →
DPO CreateTransaction → redirectUrl returned

Flow 2 · Mobile Direct (DPO)

Phone → PhoneResolution → Region
MnoDetection → confidence → MnoRouting →

Flow 3 · Callback (Daraja)

Phone → KE → Daraja STK Push
FE starts polling DB Status immediately

→ FE redirect

User completes card form → DPO callback

handleDpoCallback() → finalisePayment()

verifyPayment() one-shot → PAID

DPO CreateTransaction → reference

FE: HIGH → auto
/ AMBIGUOUS → chips / UNKNOWN → selector

chargeMobile() → ChargeTokenMobile

Poll /status → DPO verify → PAID

Daraja callback arrives → handleDarajaCallback()

finalisePayment() → PAID + entitlement

If callback delayed >20s → queryPayment() fallback

Callback is source of truth. Query is fallback only. Never fail hard on query error.

9 — RECOVERY & RESUMABILITY

Resumable orchestration

- resumePayment() → hydrates persisted session
- activeReference restored from DB
- Provider locked — prevents orchestration drift
- MNO / selection state restored
- FX context restored for display
- Polling resumes if alreadyCharged=true

Payments are resumable — but not indefinitely resumable

Bounded recovery semantics

- 15 min expiry window from createdAt
- Expired → status set FAILED, recovery stopped
- Expiry is UX boundary, NOT provider settlement truth
- Expired payment may still reconcile via async callback
- hasPaymentExpired() checked at: status, verify, sync, resume
- BG job stops retrying after expiry

10 — FINALITY & RECONCILIATION

Reconciliation layers

- Provider callback (primary)
- FE one-shot verify (UX boost)
- BG job polling + retry scheduling
- Daraja query fallback (>20s)

Provider acknowledgement ≠ durable success

Idempotency guarantees

- paymentAttemptId prevents duplicates
- Duplicate callbacks silently ignored
- finalisePayment() checks PAID before tx
- Atomic DB tx: payment update + entitlement creation

DB transaction wraps finality

Final immutable states

PAID

FAILED

EXPIRED

INITIATION_FAILED also terminal. Background job cannot resurrect any terminal state.

11 — FUTURE ARCHITECTURE (ROADMAP)

Formal FSM + transition guards

Reconciliation engine

Weighted provider routing

Provider failover

Provider health scoring

Generic transaction platform

Entitlement ledger

Transition engines

Multi-currency settlement

12 — KEY ARCHITECTURAL PRINCIPLES

Backend is execution authority

FE predicts — backend decides

Provider locking prevents orchestration drift

Orchestration must survive refreshes

Recovery is bounded — 15 min window

Adapters are execution-only

Execution state ≠ business state

Metadata is first-class orchestration state

Amounts stored in minor units — converted at boundary

FX locked at payment creation — never re-fetched

One entitlement per payment — atomic transaction

Idempotency enforced at all callback ingress